



LivePremier Plus user guide

LivePremier Plus is a **local app that puts extra panels inside an Analog Way LivePremier Web RCS session**, drawn in Web RCS's own design language so they read as part of the product rather than as a bolt-on.

- **Edit** — the Screens / Aux. page with one row instead of two, and that row is a *programmer*: a buffer that is on neither preview nor program. Build a look with the same sources, the same layer parameters and the same memory bank, and the switcher sees none of it until you save it into a memory.
- **VPU Map** — the device's mixing-resource allocation, drawn as a budget: which units are fitted, who holds them, what is spare, and what a staged preconfig would change.
- **Console** — a lighting-desk command grammar for a video switcher, which also takes raw AWJ, store writes and OSC addresses — and, on a Midra 4K or Alta 4K, routes audio.
- **Timeline** — a theatre-style cue stack that advances on one GO, with per-cue fade, delay and follow times — and cues that fire from MIDI Time Code, LTC or a pushed timecode.
- **Memories** — every memory bank in one searchable list, showing which buffer holds each one.
- **Layer** — all 67 of a layer's properties, from the switcher's own catalogue; and names for layers, which the switcher has nowhere to keep.
- **Layer Groups** — several layers, on one screen or on many, driven as one; a ganged group follows a source change made to any member, wherever it came from.
- **Send to** — a  on every source card that routes it to a screen and layer, or to a whole group, in preview or program, without a drag.
- **Matrix Routing** — patch the frame's own SDI and HDMI sockets to ports on a Blackmagic Videohub, a Lightware or a Turtle AV router, and route through it from the panel, a cue, the Console or OSC.
- **Companion** — a Bitfocus Companion served inside this app, on the same address as Web RCS: its button editor, web buttons and emulator, plus a panel that knows which switcher you are on and offers to add the connections that belong in the show.
- **Pitch Compensation** — the H and V ratios a screen spanning LED walls of different pitches needs, worked out from the pitches you give it.
- **OSC input** — QLab, TouchOSC, a lighting desk or Companion driving the switcher over UDP, with no browser open.
- **MIDI Mapping** — a control surface driving the switcher, from the page itself.
- **Pixelhue panel** (*preview*) — a Pixelhue U5, U5 Pro or U5 mini driving the switcher.
- **Your setup in one file** — cue stack, groups, layer names, router patch and settings, saved and restored together.

- **Arithmetic in the vendor's own numeric fields** — type `1080-80` into a layer width and get 1000.

Every one of these is a **plugin**: any of them can be switched off, and you can add your own — see [Switching features off](#).

The panels ride the vendor app's own WebSocket. **No second Web RCS connection to the device, no replacement UI, and nothing to install in the browser.** OSC input, the Pixelhue panel and the Edit page's direct save each open a brief AWJ connection of their own when they act — worth knowing, because the switcher allows five AWJ clients at once.

Before you rely on this: the panels render inside a real Web RCS session and the device store mirrors live — verified through this proxy against **LivePremier Simulator 6.2.73**, along with cue-stack persistence and the whole setup flow. The VPU map has been **read from a live Aquilon C** and is tested against that capture, including Optimized mode, interleaved output links, and a staged preconfig differing from the running one.

Midra 4K and Alta 4K (QuickVu, Pulse, Eikos, QuickMatrix, Zenith 100/200) are supported since 0.6.0 — Timeline, Console, Memories, Layer and Pitch Compensation; there is no VPU to map on those and MIDI Mapping is not offered there yet. The port was proven on a **live Pulse 4K**: every write over the device protocol by a test harness, and the Console panel's own lines typed by the operator — the first writes this app's panels have made to real hardware. On LivePremier, nothing has been written to a physical device yet and the timeline has only ever fired at a simulator.

The Edit page and Companion (0.10.0, 0.11.0) have been proven on simulators and a running Companion 5.0.5, not on a physical switcher. Two of their limits are worth knowing now: the Edit page's *direct* save hands the switcher a file path that the switcher resolves, so it is unproven on real hardware — its *via preview* route works anywhere — and Companion cannot add the LivePremier Plus connection until a Companion module for this app exists. The **Pixelhue panel** has never met a console at all.

0.13.0 rebuilt every feature as a plugin. Each was checked against the simulator and a Videohub emulator as it moved; what each one does did not change. A plugin of your own runs with the same access to the switcher as the app itself, so switch on only what you trust.

Built with AI assistance, directed and reviewed by a human author.

Running it

Needs **Node 20 or newer** and has no dependencies to install.

```
npm start
```

Then open `http://127.0.0.1:8535/` and give it the switcher's address. That address is remembered.

```
npm start -- --device 192.168.2.142
```

flag	meaning
<code>--device <host[:port]></code>	the switcher. Port defaults to 80 (a simulator is usually <code>:3000</code>).
<code>--port <n></code>	local port to listen on (default 8535)
<code>--host <addr></code>	local address to bind (default <code>127.0.0.1</code>). Bind a LAN address or <code>0.0.0.0</code> to reach it from other machines. On the machine running it, keep using <code>http://127.0.0.1:<port>/</code> — that is the address browsers treat as secure, which MIDI Mapping and the timecode sources need; a local browser that arrives by the LAN address is sent there automatically. Other machines get everything except those.
<code>--data <dir></code>	where cue stacks are kept

There is a desktop app too — a tray launcher with an interface and port picker.

In Docker

An image is published to `ghcr.io/stoatworks-labs/livepremier-plus` on every change to the main branch. `:latest` is the newest of those, which can be ahead of the last release; each image is also tagged with its commit, so a release can be pinned by the commit its tag points at.

```
docker run -d -p 127.0.0.1:8535:8535 -v "$PWD/config:/config" \
  ghcr.io/stoatworks-labs/livepremier-plus:latest
```

The repo's `docker-compose.yml` does the same with `docker compose up -d`, **but it publishes the port on every interface of the host** — change `8535:8535` to `127.0.0.1:8535:8535` unless the whole network is meant to reach it (see *On binding wide* below). `./config` keeps your cue stacks and the remembered switcher; set `LPP_DEVICE` to skip the setup page.

On binding wide. The default is loopback for a reason: **this proxy is an unauthenticated route to a switcher's entire control surface** — and, once a Companion is linked, to that Companion's admin UI too. `--host 0.0.0.0` hands that to everyone on the network. Do it deliberately, not by habit.

Open it through the proxy, not at the switcher

If you open the switcher's own address directly, the panels are not there and MIDI will not work.

Web MIDI is a secure-context API; `http://127.0.0.1:<port>` counts as one and a plain-HTTP LAN address does not. The panel says so rather than failing silently.

Edit — programming a look off the buses

PLUS ▶ Edit. The Screens / Aux. page, with one row per destination instead of two. Sources on the left, the destinations in the middle, the layer panel on the right — the vendor's own layout, so everything is where you already look for it. The difference is the row: it is marked **EDIT** in amber rather than PGM in red or PRW in green, because it is on neither bus.

Nothing you do here reaches the switcher. There is no TAKE, no T-bar and no padlock, because there is nothing to transition and nothing to protect.

Building a look

Each card starts empty. Three ways to fill it, and none of them asks the device for anything:

From PGM	copy what is on air into the programmer
From PRW	copy what is cued
Empty	every layer full-frame with no source, which is what an untouched preset looks like

Then work the way you would on the real page:

- **click a layer** on the card, or a row in the strip beneath it, to select it;
- **drag it** to move, or take one of the eight handles to resize — the numbers land in the Layer panel as you go, clamped to the switcher's own limits;
- **click a source** on the left to put it on the selected layer;
- **Layer** on the right is the full parameter set — all sixty-seven of them, the same panel the vendor's tab strip carries, pointed at the programmer.

Discard forgets a destination's buffer entirely; **Empty** keeps it and clears it.

Saving it into a memory

The **Memory** tab is the one control on this page that touches the switcher. Name a slot, give it a label, and choose a route:

- **Direct** — writes the memory bank itself. No preset buffer is written and no take is fired, so neither preview nor program moves. This needs the switcher to be able to read a file this app writes, which it can when both are on the same machine — a simulator, or an installation where the **Shared directory** under *Saving memories from the Edit page* (Preconfig ▶ LivePremier Plus) points at a share they both see.
- **Via preview** — puts the look into the preview buffer, fires the switcher's own save, then puts preview back property-for-property. **Program never moves.** Preview shows the look for about a second, and afterwards the bank will call it *modified* even though the content is identical — the switcher is right that the buffer was written to. Refused while a take is in flight. This route works on any switcher, and it is the only one on Midra 4K and Alta 4K.

Load into the programmer reads a slot back the other way. A memory's contents are not in the device's own data — a slot only publishes its name, its canvas and what categories it holds — so reading it out is the only way to see inside one, and it is how you pick up yesterday's look and change it.

VPU Map

PLUS ▶ VPU Map. A LivePremier configuration either fits the mixing resources the chassis has or it does not, and the switcher's own interface only tells you which by refusing it. This draws the budget instead: which VPUs are fitted, which screen holds which mixers, and what is spare.

Each VPU is drawn the way Analog Way's own manual draws one — an 8×8 field of links, layer links coming in from the left, output links running down from the top — so the picture matches the documentation you already have:

- **Native layers** sit in a band above the field, because a native is the bottom of the stack.
- **A screen that ran out of mixers** and continued onto another VPU has the two cards stacked, with the link drawn straight down out of one and into the next.
- **The header over the columns** names each link's screen, and its region and output plug where the switcher's own output figures add up.

Current and **Staged** switch between the running configuration and the one waiting in Preconfig, and a count says how many changes applying it would make — including a layer moving onto different links with every other value identical, which is still a change.

It only reads. Nothing on this page writes to the switcher. It is LivePremier only: a Midra 4K or Alta 4K has fixed processing rather than allocated mixers, so there is no budget to draw and the entry is not there.

Console

Verb first, then objects, innermost scope last. Every keyword abbreviates to any unambiguous prefix; **Enter executes and nothing is sent before it.**

```
Recall Screen 1 Memory 5
R Sc 1 Th 4 Me 5 Pre      the same command
Store Master 12
Take Screen 1
```

The line **parses as you type and shows what it will do** — Recall 3 → Screen 1 Preview — before anything reaches the device. Tab completes; ↑ recalls history.

This panel owns no grammar. Every token, rule and device path comes from [mynah](#)'s own build output — the same artefact its Companion module vendors. **If a command means the wrong thing, the fix is in mynah.**

That is worth more than tidiness: mynah's compiler and this repo's command builder were arrived at independently, and they emit **byte-identical** store paths for the commands both know. Two independent derivations agreeing is the strongest evidence either is right, and it stays true only while nobody re-types the grammar here.

Timeline

Screens / Aux. ▶ Timeline. A lighting desk's cue stack, driving a switcher: a numbered list that advances on one **GO**, where each cue recalls memories onto screens and takes them.

Each cue can carry:

fade	its own transition time, written to the screen before the take
delay	wait this long after GO before firing — a second GO during the wait fires it at once
follow	after this cue fires, fire the next one by itself, after a follow time you set
timecode	fire when incoming timecode passes this point (below)

A few things behave the way a desk does rather than the way a switcher does:

- **GO fires the standby cue, then advances. BACK** moves the pointer only.
- **The switcher's own STEP BACK is a separate, clearly-labelled button**, because it restores the device's previous state rather than replaying a cue, and the two differ as soon as a cue does more than recall and take.
- **A cue is sent, never confirmed.** The switcher answers recalls and takes with silence, so the log says what left this app and the device status is shown separately.

The editor pops out into a window of its own — useful on a second monitor while the stack runs.

Firing cues from timecode

Choose a source under **Preconfig ▶ LivePremier Plus → Timecode:**

- **MIDI Time Code** from any MIDI input the browser can see;
- **Audio (LTC)** from an audio input on this machine;
- **Pushed to LivePremier Plus** — anything that can POST a timecode to this app: a generator on another machine, a lighting desk, a script.

A cue fires **once per pass**, not on every reading. **Going backwards re-arms** it, so the same scene can be rehearsed twenty times. **Jumping forward does not run everything it skipped** — the cues

in between are marked done, silently, and the show carries on from the new position, rather than firing a hundred takes in a second.

Memories

PLUS ▶ Memories. Every memory bank in one list: master, screen and layer on a LivePremier; master, screen and aux on a Midra 4K or Alta 4K. Search by name, rename in place, and see which preset buffer is holding each memory right now — and whether it is still unmodified.

- **A recall names its target every time.** Pick **PRW** or **PGM** before you recall; there is no default, and program is coloured like the risk it is.
 - **Save and erase** do what the vendor's own buttons do, and the page says which save filters the switcher will apply before you press it.
 - **It pops out** onto a second monitor, which the vendor's own Memories tab cannot do.
-

Layer

Screens / Aux. ▶ Layer. Every one of a layer's 67 properties — source, position, size, opacity, cropping, border, transitions, effects, masks and keying — generated from the switcher's own parameter catalogue, so a firmware that adds a property grows a field for it.

You name the destination, the buffer and the layer outright, rather than the panel following what you clicked: that is React state inside the vendor's page and cannot be read, and on a second monitor a panel that stays where you pointed it turns out to be the better behaviour anyway.

- **The buffer is shown resolved:** PRW means "whichever letter is preview right now", and the panel says which letter that is. A buffer that is on air is banded in red.
- **Mid-take, it refuses to write to PRW or PGM,** because neither names a buffer honestly while a transition is running. A literal letter still works.
- **It pops out** into its own window.

Naming a layer

Type a name into **Name** and it appears everywhere a layer is listed — this panel, the groups, the ... menu, and **the vendor's own layer lists**. The switcher has no field for a layer name, so this app keeps it, per switcher; anything that talks to the switcher directly will not see it.

Layer Groups, and the ... on a source card

PLUS ▶ Layer Groups. A group is a name and a list of layers, on one screen or on several — layer 2 on screen 1 with layer 1 on screens 2 and 3 is *the side screens*. Add a layer with the destination and layer pickers at the bottom of each group card; the layer list is the device's own **fitted** list, so a slot the hardware has not got is never offered.

The two source columns beside each member show what it is showing now, in program and in preview, so a glance says whether the group agrees.

Gang: follows is on by default. The rest of the group is written to match whenever any member's source changes — by the ... menu, by the vendor's own drag-and-drop, by a memory recall, by another client. Turn it off and the group stays useful as a target and does nothing on its own.

A layer belongs to **one group at a time**; adding it somewhere takes it out of where it was, and the panel says so.

Sending an input

Every source card in the Sources panel gets a ... beside the vendor's own ⋮. The ⋮ is theirs and opens that input's settings; the ... is ours and routes it.

```
Send IN4
[ Preview ] [ Program ]
Recent      Side screens      S1 L2 · S2 L1   GANG
Groups      Side screens      S1 L2 · S2 L1   GANG
Screens     S1 [L1] [L2]      S2 [L1]
```

Preview and program mean the **role**, resolved per screen at the moment you click. Two screens sitting on opposite preset letters — which is normal — still both get it in the right buffer.

The PGM padlock is respected. With program unlocked on the screens involved, a program send goes through on one click. With it locked, you get a step naming every layer it is about to change and asking. A screen you have not got on the page has no padlock to read, so it is treated as locked and asked about too.

Mid-take nothing is sent. While a transition is in flight, "program" and "preview" do not name a buffer honestly, and the menu says so rather than guessing.

Groups are kept **per switcher**, beside the cue stack. Point the app at a different frame and you get that frame's groups.

Matrix Routing

PLUS ▶ Matrix Routing. Patch the switcher's own sockets to ports on an external router — a **Blackmagic Videohub**, a **Lightware**, or a **Turtle AV** — and route through it from here.

You describe the **cable**, and the rest follows. The direction inverts, which is the thing that reads wrong at first glance every time:

```
switcher INPUT  <--- cable ---  router OUTPUT      (the router feeds us)
switcher OUTPUT  --- cable --->  router INPUT        (we feed the router)
```

So a switcher input is fed by a router *output*, and a switcher output arrives at a router *input*. The patch form says which of the two it wants as you fill it in.

Set it up in three steps. Add the router (name, protocol, address — the port follows the protocol's own default). Patch each cable: pick a socket, pick the router, give the port number at the other end. Then route.

Sockets are named in the device's own words, because which connector "card 2, port 1" is depends on a legend this app cannot see:

```
Input 13 · card IN_2 · connector IN_25 · sdi
Output 5 · card OUT_2 · hdmi
```

The two route controls are different, and deliberately so. An input row gets a source dropdown — one choice, because a socket is fed by one router output, and it settles what that input sees. An output row gets a destination field, because the signal arrives at one router input and can go to any number of outputs at once: type `3`, or `1-4`, or `1,2,5-8`.

⚠ **Sending adds; it never takes away.** Naming outputs 1-4 routes those four and leaves output 5 alone, even if it was showing this source a moment ago. A router output always shows *something*, so "removing" a destination would mean choosing a different source for it — and there is no answer to which one.

The Now column is what the router says, not what you asked for. A click does not move the grid until the router agrees, and it keeps up with changes made at the router's own front panel or by another operator. A Videohub answers a route it will not make with an acknowledgement and the unchanged crosspoints, so a panel that showed your request back to you would look right and be wrong — during exactly the minute that matters.

On the input and output pages

You do not have to leave the socket you are working on. **Inputs ▶ an input** and **Outputs ▶ an output** carry a **Router** tab beside Signal, Aspect and the rest, and **Preconfig ▶ Inputs / Outputs** shows a **Router** box under the selected card's own boxes.

Each says which router port the cable is on — and if it is not patched yet, patch it right there — then shows the router's ports twice: as a **grid of tiles** and as a **list** with the router's own port names.

- **An input** picks one source. Click a tile or a row and it routes at once.

- **An output** picks any number of destinations. Clicking builds a selection (a dashed outline), and **Route** sends it. A solid blue tile is one the router already has on this output; the list shows what every other destination is showing now, which is what a route there would replace.

⚠ **In Preconfig this is live, not part of Apply.** The route goes to the router straight away; Apply only concerns the switcher.

From a cue, the Console and OSC

A cue can carry a matrix route beside its recalls and takes. It goes out ahead of the take, so the signal is there before anything switches to it.

⚠ **A cue does not wait for the signal to lock.** An SDI reclock is quick; an HDMI or HDCP handshake through a router can take a second or more, and nothing reports when it is done. A cue that routes and takes in one breath can take to black — put the route in an earlier cue when the format may change.

The same three addresses work typed at the Console and sent over OSC:

```
/lp/matrix/input/5/source      7      switcher input 5 now sees router input 7
/lp/matrix/output/2/destinations "1-4"    switcher output 2 out of router outputs 1-4
/lp/matrix/hub/route/3        9      router "hub": output 3 takes input 9
```

The routers are kept for the **installation**, not per switcher — a Videohub does not move when you fail over to a backup frame. The **patch** is per switcher, beside the cue stack, because it describes that frame's own sockets.

What has been proven, and what has not. The Videohub driver was driven end to end against a working implementation of the protocol, including the crosspoint numbering, which counts from zero on the wire and from one everywhere you can see. **No real Videohub has been in the loop.** The Lightware and Turtle AV drivers are written from their vendors' protocol documents and **have never spoken to the hardware at all.** docs/MATRIX.md gives a short procedure for proving each on your own kit before a show.

Companion

PLUS ▶ Companion. A [Bitfocus Companion](#) (5.0 or newer) served through this app, so its pages open on the same address as Web RCS — no second port to allow through a firewall, and nothing to switch between.

Connecting

Tick **Connect to a Companion**, give its address, and press **Connect**. The port is Companion's own admin port — 8000 unless it has been changed in Companion's settings. The link is off until you turn it on: an app that reached for a machine on the show network the moment it started would not be one you could reason about.

What is in the show

The panel lists the show's connections — label, module and status — and **follows them live**, so a connection added or disabled in Companion (including in the pages embedded below) shows up without a reload. The two it has an opinion about are highlighted:

- **AWJ** — the switcher itself: sources, presets, takes, layers.
- **LivePremier Plus** — this app: cue stack, timeline, layer groups, matrix routing.

What it does with them is an **offer, never a sync**:

- a connection already in the show is **used as it is** — its settings are left alone, whatever it is labelled;
- two of the same module is **reported, not resolved** — a show with a main and a backup frame is a correct show, and the panel will not pick one for you;
- a missing one is listed under **Not in the show yet**, with the address it would be pointed at, and **Add ... to the show** creates it and configures it for the switcher you are on. Nothing is written until you press it.

The LivePremier Plus connection cannot be added yet. It needs a LivePremier Plus module in Companion, and there is not one yet — the panel says so in those words. The AWJ connection works today.

If you opened this app on 127.0.0.1, that is the address the LivePremier Plus connection would be given, and a Companion on another machine cannot dial it. The panel warns you; open this app by its network address first if Companion is somewhere else.

Companion's own pages

Buttons, **Web buttons** and **Emulator** open Companion's real pages in the panel — the button editor itself, the touch surface a tablet would see, and a Stream Deck on screen. They are Companion, not a copy of it, so they are always the version you have installed.

Linking a Companion widens what this app exposes. Everything below `/__lpp/companion` is Companion's admin UI, reachable by anyone who can reach this app. On the default loopback binding that is only this machine; see *On binding wide* above before you change that.

Pitch Compensation

Preconfig ▶ Pitch Compensation, beside the fields it fills in. A screen spanning LED walls of different pixel pitches needs each output told how much canvas its raster is worth, or a layer crossing the join changes physical size the instant it crosses. The switcher has the fields for it — **Preconfig ▶ Canvas ▶ Pitch**, **H Ratio** and **V Ratio** — and no help working out what to put in them.

It knows every number but one. The panel reads the rasters, the outputs on the screen and the ratios already set, and asks you only for the pitches — one per output: `2.6`, or `2.6 x 3.0` if the pixels really are not square.

- A **coarser** wall takes a ratio **above** 1.000 — the ratio multiplies a raster to give its footprint on the canvas.
- A ratio the switcher would not accept is **refused here** rather than sent: the device discards an out-of-range write instead of clamping it.
- **Applying takes two presses.** It is a preconfig change that moves every output on the screen at once, so it should be hard to hit by accident. If the switcher already holds the computed ratios, the button says so and does nothing.

OSC input

Off until you turn it on in **Preconfig ▶ LivePremier Plus → OSC input**. Then this app listens on a UDP port, and QLab, TouchOSC, a lighting desk or Companion can drive the switcher — **with no browser open**.

```
/lp/screen/1/take  
/lp/screen/1/memory/5/recall/preview  
/lp/master/memory/12/store  
/lp/screen/1/preset/a/layer/2/opacity/opacity/norm 0.5
```

Every address, its argument and its range is in [docs/OSC.md](#) — generated from the same tables that resolve the messages, so it cannot list an address that does not work.

- **The address is the target; the argument is only the value.** A button with a fixed address and no argument still means something specific.
- **A trigger fires on a non-zero argument and on none at all** — surfaces send 1 on press and 0 on release, and firing on both would take the screen twice.
- **A recall never defaults to program.** `.../recall` goes to preview.
- `/norm` **takes 0–1 and scales**; without it the value is in the switcher's own units — opacity is 0–256, not 0–100.
- **Live layer parameters must name a buffer** — `/a`, `/b` or `/c`. Over UDP there is no way to know which letter is preview at this instant, so `preview` and `program` are refused with that reason rather than guessed. The Console can resolve them.

It binds to this machine only unless you choose otherwise, and the other option says in as many words that the network will be able to fire takes.

MIDI Mapping

Under **Virtual RC400T**. Pick an input, an output for feedback, and a controller profile; press Start. Faders, encoders and buttons then drive the selected layer.

The engine is [awj-surface](#)'s, vendored whole along with its stock profiles — X-Touch/Mackie, APC40, MIDIcon 2 and Pro, plus a generic learn profile.

Soft pickup is the behaviour worth knowing. A non-motorised fader will not move a live value until it has swept *through* that value, so picking up a fader mid-show cannot jump a layer's opacity. **The panel shows the hold-off rather than looking broken** — if a fader appears dead, that is what you are seeing.

Pixelhue panel (preview)

A Pixelhue **U5**, **U5 Pro** or **U5 mini** event controller, driving the switcher. Off until you turn it on in **Preconfig** ▶ **LivePremier Plus** → **Pixelhue panel**.

It does not map keys. The console is handed a model of this switcher — its screens, inputs and memories — and labels, lights and pages its own keys from it; what comes back is what the operator meant: *select screen S2, put input 2 on the selected layer, take*. So there is nothing to remap when a firmware moves a key.

- A **U5 mini** answers on the network, so it is driven from wherever this app already runs.
- A **U5** or **U5 Pro** serves its control port to itself only, so this app has to run on the console — a Windows mini-PC with a touch screen, which runs the proxied Web RCS perfectly well.

 **This has never been run against a real console.** It was built from the consoles' firmware and proved against the vendor's own control service running with no panel attached. Treat the first show with one as a rehearsal. Fade-to-black and freeze, which the console asks for, are not sent yet.

Arithmetic in numeric fields

Type an expression into one of Web RCS's own numeric fields and it is evaluated when you commit — on Enter, or on leaving the field:

typed	becomes
1080-80	1000
(1920-40)/2	940
1920*2	3840

`+` `-` `*` `/` `(` `)` and decimals, with the usual precedence. **The result is clamped to the field's own declared range and rounded to its step**, so a width of `9000+1000` lands on 8192 rather than being refused.

Nothing else about the field changes: the vendor still validates it, still decides what to send, and still drags the other axis along if the aspect lock is on.

Where it applies is narrow on purpose. Only fields the vendor itself marks as numeric by putting `min`, `max` and `step` on them. That excludes everything that must not be touched — labels have no `step`, and neither does the transition-time field, whose `00:01.000` would be mangled by anything treating `:` as arithmetic.

Opacity and zoom are deliberately excluded. They are real number inputs, and a number input *discards* anything it cannot parse — after typing `1080-80` the browser reports an empty value, and the expression is visible on screen but unreadable from script. Winning arithmetic there would mean mutating a vendor element's type on every focus, in a UI driving a live show. Not a good trade.

There is **no** `eval` anywhere in this path; anything the parser does not fully understand is refused rather than guessed at.

The demo environment

```
npm run demo
```

brings the whole thing up against a **LivePremier Simulator**, with a real Aquilon C's resource map folded in and an example cue stack loaded, so every panel has something real to show without a switcher in the room.

The simulator has **no VPU at all**, so the panel against a bare one correctly reports there is nothing to draw; the demo supplies that from the recorded capture — 32 of 64 mixers fitted, 26 allocated, one screen in Optimized mode, and a staged preconfig differing in 26 mixers. Everything outside that stays the simulator's own live state, **so cues fired from the timeline really do go on the wire**.

It refuses to run against anything that is not loopback. The demo splices a store subtree and seeds a cue stack, and "I thought it was the simulator" is exactly the mistake worth making impossible.

The demo's cue stack lives in a temporary directory and is deleted on exit; your own is never touched.

Switching features off

Preconfig ▶ LivePremier Plus → Plugins lists every feature this app adds, each with a switch. Everything is on until you switch it off.

- A switched-off feature is **gone, not hidden**: no sidebar entry or tab, nothing added to the vendor's page, and no background service — an OSC listener closes, router and Companion connections hang up.
- **Reload the page** after a change. The server side applies straight away; the page picks it up on the next load, and the card reminds you.
- Some features need others. **Send to** needs **Layer Groups**, and **Timecode** needs the **Timeline**: switch Groups off and Send to goes with it, marked *needs Layer Groups*, and comes back when Groups does.
- A feature's own switch is separate. Switching **OSC input** on as a plugin brings its settings back; the listener itself still starts off until you tick *Listen for OSC*.

Adding a plugin of your own

A plugin somebody wrote — or you did — is a folder you put in the **plugins folder of the app's data directory**: `~/.livepremier-plus/plugins/` for the desktop app, `/config/plugins/` in Docker.

1. Copy the plugin's folder in, and **restart the app**.
2. In **Preconfig ▶ LivePremier Plus → Plugins** it is listed under **Added by you**, switched off.
3. Tick it. You are asked to confirm, because a plugin runs inside this app with full control of it and of the switcher. **Only switch on plugins you trust**. Then reload the page.

Nothing in a plugin's folder runs until you switch it on. A folder that is not a working plugin is listed with the reason instead. The app's source has an example to start from in `examples/plugins/hello-switcher`, and `docs/PLUGINS.md` is the guide to writing one.

Saving and restoring your setup

A `.awc` from the switcher restores the *processor* — inputs, outputs, screens, memories. It holds nothing about this app: your cue stack, your layer groups, the names you gave layers, the patch to the external routers. Restore a `.awc` on its own onto a fresh frame and the show comes back with no cue list.

So this app can write all of that into one file:

```
curl -o livepremier-plus.json 'http://127.0.0.1:8535/___lpp/config?download=1'
```

It is plain JSON — readable, diffable, fine in a git repo. It carries which switcher it was written against, and three separate groups:

- **installation** — app settings (console language, OSC port and bind) and your external routers. Not tied to a switcher.
- **show** — the cue stack, layer groups and layer names. Tied to the switcher they were built on, because they name screens and layer slots like `S1/2`.
- **rig** — the patch between the frame and the routers.

To restore, POST it back:

```
curl -X POST -H 'content-type: application/json' \
  --data-binary @livepremier-plus.json \
  http://127.0.0.1:8535/___lpp/config
```

By default that restores the show and the rig and your routers, and **leaves the app settings alone** — a restore should not quietly change the OSC port a lighting desk is sending to. Ask for them explicitly if you want them:

```
{ "doc": { ... }, "sections": ["stack", "groups", "names", "patch", "settings"] }
```

Reload any open page afterwards. The restore reaches the running app at once — the routers are dialled, the patch and any settings you asked for are the ones in force — but a Web RCS page that was already open still holds the cue stack, groups and names it loaded, and its next save would put those back. The answer to the restore says `"reloadPages": true` when that applies.

A feature that is switched off is left out of both: its section is not written, and a file that has one reports it as skipped rather than restoring it. A plugin of your own can add a section of its own — see [PLUGINS.md](#).

Onto a different frame. The device-keyed parts land under whichever switcher this app is currently pointed at, so failing over to a backup frame at another address is just: point the app at the backup, then POST the file. Add `"device": "192.168.2.141"` to send it somewhere else again. To see what a file would do before doing it, POST it to `/___lpp/config/inspect`.

Both halves in one file. [Showbook](#) keeps this file beside the `.awc` for the same show and exports the pair as one `.showbook` bundle — or, if you want a single file you can restore straight from the switcher's own Web RCS, it can put this configuration *inside* the `.awc`. The switcher accepts it and ignores it; this app reads it back out. Note the switcher does not keep it: a `.awc` you export from Web RCS afterwards will not contain it.

If something is wrong

Symptom	Cause
No panels in Web RCS	You opened the switcher's address directly. Go through the proxy.
MIDI does nothing	Same cause — Web MIDI needs a secure context, which loopback is and a LAN address is not.
A fader does not move anything	Soft pickup. Sweep it through the current value.
A console command means the wrong thing	The grammar is mynah's; the fix is there.
Arithmetic does not work in a field	It is not one the vendor marks numeric — opacity and zoom are deliberately excluded.
The VPU panel says there is nothing to draw	A simulator has no VPU. That is correct, not a failure.
The demo refuses to start	It only runs against loopback, on purpose.